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Low Flying Training

https://api.parliament.uk/historic-hansard/written_answers/1998/mar/30/low-flying-training

HC Deb 30 March 1998 vol 309 cc414-5W

[414W]

Helen Jackson

To ask the Secretary of State for Defence (1) what complaints were received by the RAF concerning low-flying aircraft relating to 24 March 1997; [36407]

if RAF/NATO military aircraft were engaged on an exercise over Northern England between 9.30 and 10.30 pm on 24 March 1997; [36404]

for what reasons the RAF imposed an air exclusion zone around Howden reservoir on the morning of 25 March 1997; [36408]

what reported sightings of UFOs were received from the (a)public and (b)police from the South Yorkshire/ Derbyshire area on 24 and 25 March 1997. [36402]

Mr. Spellar

A number of military aircraft were booked to carry out low flying training in northern England on the evening of 24 March 1997. The Ministry of Defence received 13 complaints about aircraft activity for that date from locations across the UK. No reported sightings of "UFOs" on 24 or 25 March 1997 were received by my Department. A Temporary Danger Area was established on 25 March, centred on Howden Reservoir, to allow an RAF Search and Rescue helicopter, [415W] in response to a request for assistance from South Yorkshire Police, to carry out a search of the area without disturbance by other military aircraft. Such Danger Areas are routinely established for Search and Rescue operations.

Sonic Booms (Sheffield)

https://api.parliament.uk/historic-hansard/written_answers/1998/mar/30/sonic-booms-sheffield

HC Deb 30 March 1998 vol 309 c415W

[415W]

Helen Jackson

To ask the Secretary of State for Defence if an RAF/NATO aircraft was responsible for the two sonic booms above Sheffield detected by Edinburgh University Seismology Unit at 21.52 and 22.06 on 24 March 1997. [36405]

Mr. Spellar

We have no record of sonic events being generated by RAF or NATO aircraft for the evening of 24 March 1997.

Low Flying

https://api.parliament.uk/historic-hansard/written_answers/1998/mar/30/low-flying

HC Deb 30 March 1998 vol 309 c393W

[393W]

Helen Jackson

To ask the Secretary of State for the Home Department what complaints were received by police forces relating to low-flying aircraft on 24 March 1997. [36403]

Mr. Michael

Information on complaints to the police of low-flying aircraft is not held centrally. I understand that on the evening of 24 March 1997, South Yorkshire Police received reports of a low-flying aircraft which was thought to have crashed. An investigation by the police and other authorities failed to find any trace of the aircraft.

Low Flying Training

https://api.parliament.uk/historic-hansard/written_answers/1998/apr/07/low-flying-training

HC Deb 07 April 1998 vol 310 c222W

[222W]

Helen Jackson

To ask the Secretary of State for Defence, pursuant to his answers of 30 March 1998,Official Report, column 414, if the military exercises were carried out over the Sheffield area; what regulations govern (a) military and (b) other aircraft breaking the sound barrier; and if the sonic booms detected by Edinburgh University Seismology Unit above Sheffield, on 24 March 1997 were the result of aircraft breaking the sound barrier. [37991]

Mr. Spellar

It is not possible, twelve months after the date in question, to state precisely where military aircraft activity was being carried out. Records kept show only that aircraft were booked to carry out low flying over the Peak District between 2030 and 2107 hours local time on the evening of 24 March 1997. No low level flying is permitted over the Sheffield urban area, or any other major conurbation. Records of flying at medium level—between 2,000 and 24,000 feet—are not maintained so it is possible that there were aircraft in the area at medium level.

The regulations governing military aircraft flying at supersonic speeds are contained in the Joint Service Publication entitled 'Military Flying Regulations', an extract of which was provided in the answer I gave her on 1 April 1998, Official Report, columns 547–48. The regulations which apply to civil aviation are a matter for my hon. Friend the Parliamentary Under-Secretary of State for the Environment, Transport and the Regions.

As for the sonic event detected by the British Geological Survey at Edinburgh University, I refer my hon. Friend to the answer I gave her on 30 March 1998, Official Report, columns 414–15.